Gloxad Web ↔ Backend API Integration Report

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Summary

The web app now sends every API call to the Render backend (`https://gloxard-backend.onrender.com/api`). Before this change, only `/api/auth/*` reached Render and everything else went to `localhost:3001`.

Public endpoints were tested end to end. Everything behind a login was wired to match the published API reference but has **not yet been tested with a signed-in account**. The backend still needs 6 undocumented endpoints confirmed, 6 missing features, 2 CORS settings and some field names made consistent (see Backend action items).

Confirmed working

These were tested through the local app's proxy against the live Render backend.

Check	Result
`GET /api/health`	200, returns status and uptime
`GET /api/categories`	200, returns 3 categories with sub-categories and topics
`GET /api/courses`	200, returns published courses with pagination
Protected routes without a token (`/auth/me`, `/admin/categories`, `/upload/presigned-url`, `/auth/update-profile`)	401 "Authentication token missing or malformed", so the routes exist and are guarded
Admin courses, settings, course upload wizard, tutor onboarding pages	Compile and load (HTTP 200)
Signed-out access to protected pages	Redirects to sign-in
Project type-check (`tsc --noEmit`)	Passes

Wired to the API, not yet tested signed in

Each row now matches the published API reference. Each one needs one pass with a seed account to confirm.

Feature	Endpoint(s)	What was fixed
Admin: list categories	`GET /categories`	Page crashed: it expected a plain list, not `{ categories: [...] }`
Admin: create category with image and sub-categories	`POST /admin/categories`, `POST /upload/presigned-url`	Now sends name, order, icon and sub-categories with topics
Admin: edit category	`PUT /admin/categories/:id`	Edit button did nothing
Admin: add, rename, delete sub-categories	`PUT /admin/categories/:id`	Buttons were not connected
Admin: delete category	`DELETE /admin/categories/:id`	Shows the 409 message when courses still use it
Profile: name, title, skills, bio	`PUT /auth/update-profile`	Added skills; stopped sending a temporary preview URL as the avatar
Profile: photo upload	`POST /upload/presigned-url` + S3 `PUT`	Used folder `profile-pictures`, which the API rejects; now `avatars`
Profile: social links, notification settings	`PUT /auth/update-profile`	Page now refreshes after saving
Profile: change password	`POST /auth/update-password`	Moved into the auth service
Course wizard: category and sub-category dropdowns	`GET /categories`	Was broken; sub-categories now follow the chosen category
Course wizard: video, notes, caption uploads	`POST /upload/presigned-url`	Used folders `videos`, `documents`, `captions`; now `courses` or `resources`

Feature	Endpoint(s)	What was fixed
Tutor: submit credentials	`POST /upload/presigned-url`, `POST /tutor/showcase-expertise`	Posted raw files to a missing endpoint; now uploads to S3, then sends JSON
Tutor: appeal a rejected course	`POST /tutor/courses/:id/appeal`	Sent `reason`; now sends `message`
Admin: resolve or dismiss appeal	`PUT /admin/appeals/:id/status`	Sent `adminNotes` and `"rejected"`; now `resolutionNotes` and `resolved` or `dismissed`
Admin: broadcast to students	`POST /admin/broadcast`	Sent `role`; now `targetRole`, `title`, `message`
Real-time messaging	Socket.io handshake	Now sends `auth: { token }`
Courses, enrollments, notifications, admin dashboard, finance	Existing calls	Already used the right paths; they now reach Render instead of `localhost:3001`

Backend action items

The first item matters most: these screens call endpoints that aren't in the API reference. They can't be verified because every `/admin` and `/tutor` route returns 401 before reporting whether it exists.

1. Endpoints the frontend calls that are not documented

Please confirm each one exists, or add it and document it.

Endpoint	Used by	Needed for
`GET /admin/users/:id`	Admin tutor profile and tutor verification pages	One user's full profile and credentials

Endpoint	Used by	Needed for
`GET /admin/courses/:id`	Admin course approval details	Full unshielded course for review; frontend falls back to `GET /courses/:id` on 404, which likely hides pending courses
`GET /admin/reviews`, `DELETE /admin/reviews/:id`	Admin reviews page	Review moderation
`GET /tutor/reviews`, `POST /tutor/reviews/:id/reply`	Tutor reviews page	Tutors reading and answering reviews
`POST /courses/:id/reviews`	Course details page	Students leaving a rating and comment
`GET /tutor/search-instructors?q=`	Course wizard, publish step	Adding co-instructors

2. Missing features

- [ ] **Admin platform settings** (allow sign-ups, allow password reset, account deletion grace days): no endpoint, so the toggles don't save.
- [ ] **Certificate signature:** no field to store the admin signature image used on certificates.
- [ ] **Category image:** categories only have `icon` (a text name). The frontend stores an uploaded image URL there for now. A dedicated `imageUrl` field would be cleaner.
- [ ] **Experience proofs:** `showcase-expertise` has only `certifications` and one `certificationsUrl`. Tutors upload certificates and experience proofs separately, so both end up in `certifications`. Add an `experienceProofs` array.
- [ ] **Token refresh:** `POST /auth/refresh` returns 404. Tokens last 7 days, then users are signed out with no warning.
- [ ] **Course reviews and ratings:** `rating` exists on courses, but no documented endpoint creates a review.

3. Configuration

- [ ] **S3 CORS:** the browser uploads straight to S3 with the signed URL. The bucket must allow `PUT` from the web app's domains (localhost:3000 and production).
- [ ] **API CORS:** responses allow only `http://localhost:3000`. Add the production web domain before deploying the frontend.

4. Field names that differ between endpoints

The frontend handles these, but one shape everywhere would remove bugs.

Field	Signup / verify-email	`/auth/me`
Email verified	`isEmailVerified`	`isVerified`
Biography	`biography`	`bio`
Social links	`socialLinks`	`socials`
Avatar in messages	`avatarUrl` (elsewhere)	`avatar` (messages, conversations)

Also, `GET /admin/courses/pending` returns `category` as an id, while `/courses` returns the category name.

Frontend follow-ups

- [ ] Test every row in "Wired to the API" with the seed accounts (`admin@gloxad.com` , `jane.tutor@gloxad.com` , `alice.student@gloxad.com`).
- [ ] Make sub-category optional in the course wizard; today a category with no sub-categories blocks tutors.
- [ ] Fix the Jest setup: all 15 test suites fail before running, on `main` too.
- [ ] Set up ESLint (`next lint` has no config).
- [ ] Commit the changes (30 files, not yet committed).